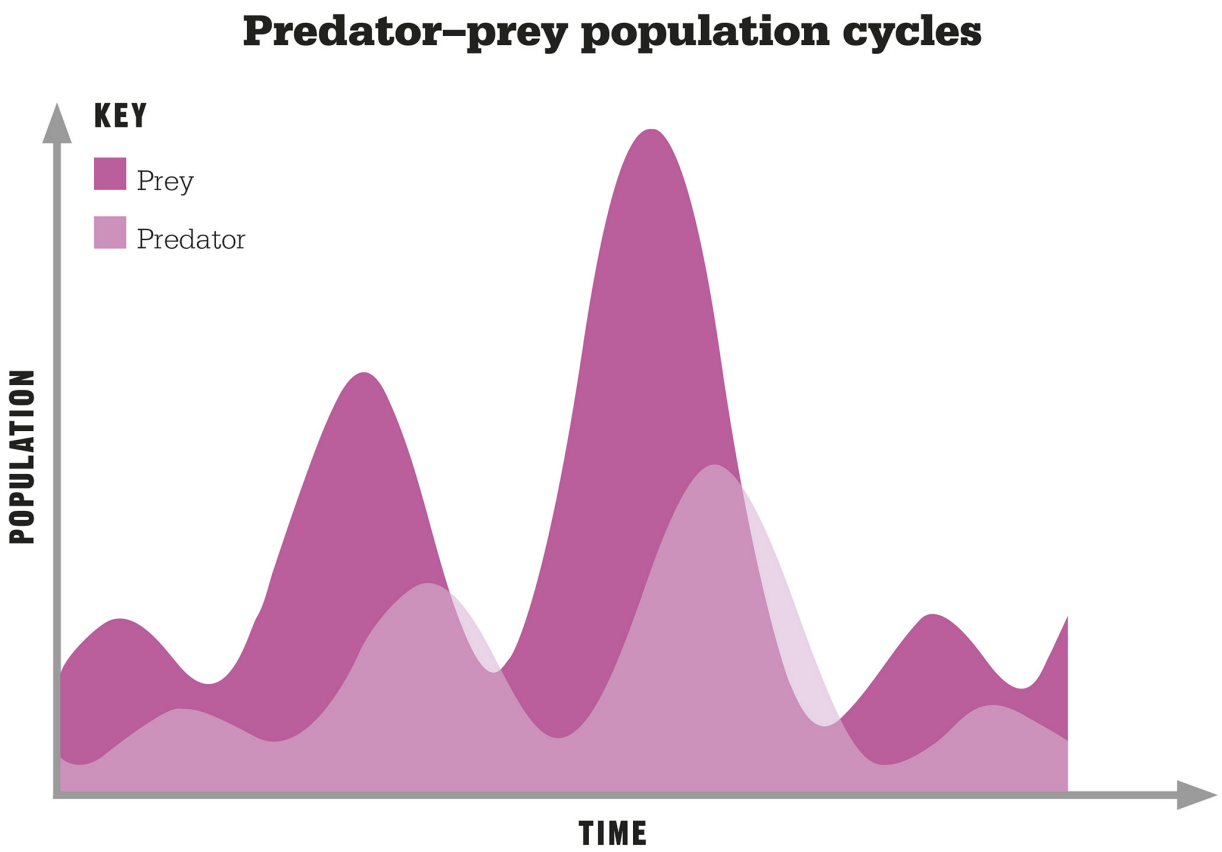


The predator and prey populations rise and fall over time in regular cycles. Although the degree to which they change varies, the cycle follows a broadly similar pattern.

Read accessible description

“Mathematics without natural history is sterile, but natural history without mathematics is muddled.”

John Maynard Smith

British mathematician and evolutionist

Nature’s arms race

The predator–prey equations revealed that species are locked together in a never-ending struggle, swinging from near disaster and extinction to times of abundance and fertility. In this biological “arms race,” the evolutionary